

Unit 3: Places

The secret room: parts of buildings and the Past continuous

Lesson 3-3
Book pages 72–75

💡 **Big idea:** In the mystery story **The secret room**, Eddie finds a secret room in an old palace. We use the **Past continuous** (was/were + -ing) for a **longer action** in the past, and the **Past simple** for a **shorter action** that happens in the middle of it.

🎯 **I will learn:**
- Read a mystery story
- Learn words for parts of buildings
- Use the Past continuous with the Past simple

📖 Key words

ceiling سقف من الداخل	**floor** أرضية	**wall** جدار	**roof** سطح المبنى
corridor ممر	**stairs** درج	**lift** مصعد	**escalator** سلم كهربائي
entrance مدخل	**exit** مخرج		

The secret room (Book club)

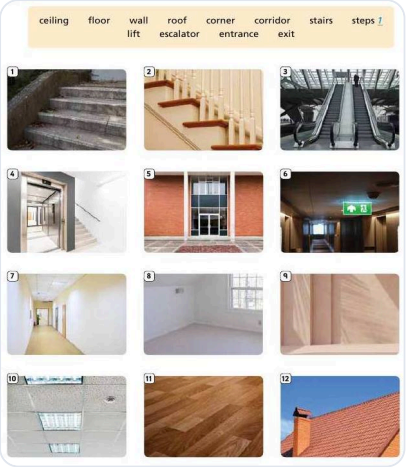
- A mystery story always has **a puzzle to solve** and often a kind of **detective**
- Eddie and his sister Carrie visit **Bingley Palace**
- Eddie sees that the picture of the palace is wrong: there are only two windows in the tower
- He was touching a bookcase when it **moved** and he fell
- He found a **secret room** with Lady Charlotte's lost paintings

Parts of buildings

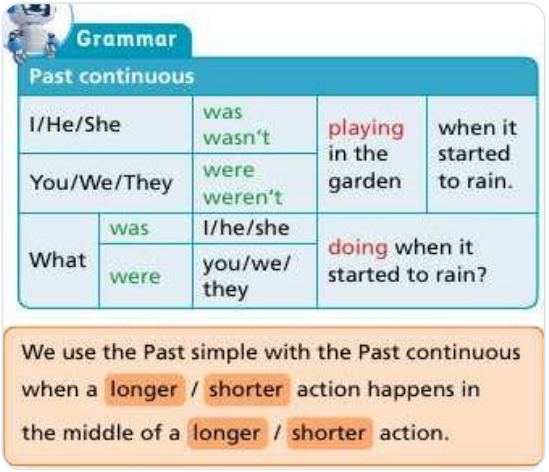
- ceiling
- floor
- wall
- roof
- corner
- corridor
- stairs
- steps
- lift
- escalator
- entrance
- exit

Past continuous

- Form: **was / were + verb-ing**
- I/He/She **was** playing
- You/We/They **were** playing
- Question: What **were** you doing?
- Use Past continuous for the **longer** action and Past simple for the **shorter** action: She **was playing** in the garden **when** it **started** to rain.



Parts of buildings



Grammar: Past continuous

✏️ Examples

Eddie ___ (touch) a bookcase when it moved.

Answer: Eddie was touching a bookcase when it moved.

What ___ you doing at 8 o'clock?

Answer: What were you doing at 8 o'clock?

⭐ Remember

- I/he/she/it → **was**
- you/we/they → **were**
- long action + when + short action

⚠️ Watch out

- They was playing ✗ → They **were** playing ✓

🧩 **Activity:** Talk about your earliest memories: Where were you? What were you doing? What happened?

✅ Check yourself

1. What did Eddie find?
2. Which is longer, was talking or fell?
3. What do we call moving stairs?

Answers: (1) a secret room ، (2) was talking ، (3) an escalator